FERPA DLP Pack — Microsoft Purview

Implementation Solution Guide

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Contents

Executive Summary — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview) 4

The problem . . . 4

The solution . . . 4

What it delivers . . . 4

Business outcomes . . . 4

Boundaries (so scope is clear) . . . 5

1. Solution Overview — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview) 5

What this solution is . . . 5

Why this matters . . . 6

How it works . . . 6

The five DLP locations (and what each controls for education records) . . . 7

The simulate→enforce journey (the core discipline) . . . 7

What you can control . . . 7

Limitations (be honest with buyers) . . . 8

Naming convention (used in every doc and script) . . . 8

The standard deployment model . . . 9

2. Requirements — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview) 9

2.1 Licensing sufficient for the DLP features you will use — especially Endpoint DLP . . . 9

2.2 DLP-specific least-privilege roles . . . 9

2.3 Devices onboarded to Purview for Endpoint DLP . . . 10

2.4 An education-record classification intent and a student-identifier SIT inventory . . . 10

2.5 Source data for Exact Data Match (only if EDM is used) . . . 11

2.6 A pilot ring, simulation dwell time, and change control (DLP-specific) . . . 11

2.7 An incident/alert triage owner and destination . . . 12

Global Requirements — Microsoft Purview Solutions 13

1. Microsoft 365 tenant with the required Purview/compliance licensing . . . 13

2. Purview roles (least-privilege) and portal access . . . 13

3. Security & Compliance PowerShell + Graph toolchain . . . 13

4. Data sources & scope in scope . . . 14

5. Compliance, records, privacy & legal stakeholders . . . 14

6. A pilot scope and change control . . . 14

3. Implementation Guide — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview) 15

Phase 0 — Connect and baseline (Assess) . . . 15

Phase 1 — Design the classification layer (SITs & classifiers for education records) . . . 16

Phase 2 — Build the DLP policies in SIMULATION (Configure — no user impact) . . . 16

Phase 3 — Measure and tune (drive false positives down) . . . 17
Phase 4 — Enforce in a pilot ring (Pilot) . . . 18
Phase 5 — Expand and harden (Enforce → Operate) . . . 18
Order-of-operations summary . . . 19
5. Testing & Validation — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview) 19
Test A — Detection & enforcement (record leaks are blocked) . . . 20
Test B — False-positive rate (adoption gate) . . . 20
Test C — Incident / alert handling (the control is operable) . . . 21
Simulation-first & rollback validation . . . 22
Evidence to capture (for the deliverable record) . . . 22
6. Troubleshooting — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview) 23
Policy / detection . . . 23
Endpoint DLP . . . 24
False positives (the adoption killer) . . . 24
Alerts / incident handling . . . 25
Connectivity / tooling . . . 25
7. Best Practices — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview) 26
Simulate before you enforce — always . . . 26
Get the student-identifier classification right . . . 27
Tune for a low false-positive rate (adoption depends on it) . . . 27
Respect the directory-vs-non-directory boundary . . . 27
Right-size the user experience . . . 27
Endpoint DLP specifics . . . 28
Operations & governance . . . 28
Stay inside the boundary . . . 28
8. Deliverables Summary — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview) 29
Documentation . . . 29
PowerShell tools (5) — Security & Compliance PowerShell / Graph . . . 29
Definition of done . . . 30
Appendix A — PowerShell Scripts 32

Executive Summary — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview)

The problem

Student **education records** — grades, disciplinary records, student identifiers, financial-aid data, and the personally identifiable information tied to them — leave the institution through the channels people use every day: an email with a class roster attached, an "anyone with the link" gradebook share, a student ID pasted into Teams, or a records file copied to USB or printed from a faculty laptop. FERPA (20 U.S.C. § 1232g; 34 CFR Part 99) requires those records to be protected; without a working data-loss control, leaks are invisible until they become an incident. The common failed attempt — switching data-loss controls straight to "block" — floods the help desk with false positives and gets turned off within a week.

The solution

Stand up **Microsoft Purview Data Loss Prevention (DLP)**, tuned for education records, across all five locations — **Exchange email, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams, and Endpoint (managed devices)** — using only the Microsoft Purview portal, Security & Compliance PowerShell, and Microsoft Graph. Detection is driven by **sensitive information types** (built-in SSN/name/address types, a **custom Student ID SIT** tuned to your local format, and **Exact Data Match** against the real records where near-zero false positives matter), and the defining discipline is that **every policy is built and proven in SIMULATION first** — Microsoft's built-in test mode that shows what *would* be blocked, with zero user impact — then tuned for a **low false-positive rate**, then enforced to a **pilot ring**, then expanded. The result: record leaks are blocked without blocking teaching and administration.

What it delivers

- A mapped **classification layer** for education records — the right detector for each in-scope category,

reusing built-in types and adding a Student ID custom SIT / EDM / trainable classifiers only for real gaps.

- **DLP policies across email, cloud, Teams, and endpoint**, each proven in simulation, tuned, and enforced

through policy tips, user justification/override, or block.

- A **measured false-positive rate** kept at/under an agreed threshold — the difference between a control

faculty trust and one they ignore.

- An **incident/alert triage workflow** so every match is acted on, with an evidence trail in Activity

Explorer, least-privilege evidence access, and optional SIEM forwarding.

- **Five PowerShell tools** (posture assessment, policy config helper, validation checker, match/false-

positive report, scope helper) — read-only or `-WhatIf` by default, no credentials in code.

Business outcomes

- **Record leaks blocked** across the channels student data actually walks out through — email, cloud

sharing, and USB/print on endpoints.

• **Minimal disruption** — simulation-first plus tuning means the control catches leaks without a wave of false positives, and any policy reverts to simulation instantly if needed.

• **Operable and auditable** — matches raise alerts that are triaged to disposition, with evidence retained for a defensible FERPA compliance posture.

• **Self-guided at a fraction of consulting cost** — the same method a specialist would use, documented and tooled to run in-house.

Boundaries (so scope is clear)

DLP is licensing-/plan-dependent — **Endpoint DLP and advanced classifiers require E5 / E5 Compliance (or A5) and onboarded devices** (verify your tenant). This solution provides the **technical configuration and the evidence**; *which* records are FERPA-protected, what is **directory** versus **non-directory** information, which disclosures are permitted, the **enforced action per category**, and the **acceptable false-positive threshold** are **FERPA-compliance, registrar, privacy, and legal determinations**, captured alongside the delivered evidence.

1. Solution Overview — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview)

What this solution is

Student **education records** — grades, disciplinary and counseling records, student identifiers, financial aid data, and the personally identifiable information tied to them — leave educational institutions through the same everyday channels everyone uses: an email with a class roster attached, a gradebook shared "anyone with the link" from OneDrive or SharePoint, a student ID number pasted into a Teams chat, or a spreadsheet of records copied to a USB stick or printed from a faculty laptop. **Microsoft Purview Data Loss Prevention (DLP)** detects and controls that movement by matching the *content* being shared against **sensitive information types (SITs)** and **classifiers**, then applying a policy action — audit only, warn the user with a **policy tip**, allow with a business **justification**, or **block** — across **Exchange email, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams, and Endpoint (managed devices)**.

This is the **FERPA-aligned DLP pack**: a repeatable, evidence-driven way to stand up education-record detection and protection policies in Microsoft Purview using only the **Microsoft Purview portal**, **Security & Compliance PowerShell** (`Connect-IPPSSession`), and **Microsoft Graph** — no third-party DLP tooling. Its defining discipline is that **every policy is built and proven in SIMULATION mode first** (Microsoft's built-in test mode that evaluates policy against real traffic and shows what *would* have matched, with zero user impact), tuned for a low false-positive rate, and only then moved to enforcement.

> ***Scope boundary — FERPA determinations are deferred.*** *This solution delivers the **technical method and evidence** for education-record DLP. *Which* records are FERPA-protected, what counts as **directory information** (disclosable without consent unless the student/parent has opted out) versus **non-directory PII** (which requires consent), which disclosures are permitted, and the **enforced action** per data category are **FERPA-compliance, registrar, privacy, and legal determinations** — deferred to those functions. The solution helps you configure and prove the control; it does not make the FERPA*

determination. (FERPA: 20 U.S.C. § 1232g; 34 CFR Part 99 — applicability is the institution's counsel to confirm.)

Why this matters

• DLP that is switched straight to **enforce** without simulation is the classic failure: it blocks

legitimate teaching and administration, floods the help desk, and gets disabled within a week. Simulation-first is the difference between a control that survives and one that is turned off.

• **Student identifiers are institution-specific.** There is no reliable built-in "student ID" detector —

student ID formats are local, so accurate detection usually needs a **custom SIT** (or **Exact Data Match** against the SIS export), tuned to your ID scheme. Getting this classification layer right is what makes the control trusted.

• **Directory vs non-directory is a policy decision, not a technical default.** The same name-and-address

content may be freely disclosable directory information for one student and protected for another who has opted out. DLP detects the *content*; the registrar/FERPA function decides the *treatment*.

• **Endpoint DLP is licensing- and onboarding-dependent** — it requires the right plan and devices onboarded

to Purview (shared with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint onboarding). A policy scoped to the Devices location does nothing until the endpoints are actually onboarded and reporting.

• False positives are the enemy of adoption. A detector that fires on every internal reference number trains

faculty and staff to ignore every policy tip. Tuning — confidence levels, instance counts, supporting keywords, and EDM — is what makes the control usable.

How it works

1. **Sensitive information types (SITs) and classifiers** define *what* to look for. Purview ships 150+

built-in SITs (e.g. *U.S. Social Security Number (SSN)*, *All Full Names*, *U.S. Physical Addresses*, *U.S. Bank Account Number*), and you can add **custom SITs** (regex + keyword + confidence) for local identifiers such as a **Student ID**, **Exact Data Match (EDM)** SITs (matched against a hashed upload of your real SIS/records export for near-zero false positives), and **trainable classifiers** for conceptual categories (e.g. transcripts, disciplinary letters). *Whether a regulatory DLP policy template (for example a FERPA-labeled template) is available in your tenant is licensing-/version-dependent — verify in your tenant; do not assume one exists.*

1. **DLP policies** bind those SITs to **locations** (Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams chat/channel, and

Devices/Endpoint) with **conditions** (which SIT, how many instances, what confidence), **actions** (audit / notify / restrict / block; restrict USB/print/cloud-app upload on endpoint), and **user experience** (policy tips, allow-with-justification, allow-override).

1. **Simulation mode** runs the policy against live traffic and records what *would* have matched — with or

without policy tips shown — so you can see the true hit volume and false positives **before** any enforcement. Every policy in this pack starts here.

1. **Tuning** reduces false positives using confidence levels, instance thresholds, supporting keyword evidence, EDM, and exceptions — measured against the simulation results.

1. **Enforcement** turns the tuned policy on (tips/override/block) in a limited ring, then expands.

2. **Incident/alert handling** — DLP rule matches raise **alerts** in the Purview portal and DLP events flow to **Activity Explorer**; this pack wires the triage, severity, and response workflow so matches are actually acted on.

The five DLP locations (and what each controls for education records)

• **Exchange (email):** rosters, grade reports, and records emailed to unintended or external recipients; block or encrypt on match.

• **SharePoint & OneDrive:** gradebooks and record files at rest and when shared; block external sharing on match.

• **Teams chat & channel messages:** student identifiers or record content pasted into messages.

• **Endpoint (Devices):** activities on **onboarded** Windows/macOS devices — copy records to USB, copy to network share, print, upload to unallowed cloud apps/browsers, copy to clipboard, paste to browser. **Requires onboarding and the right licensing.**

• **On-premises / Fabric / Power BI / cloud apps (Defender for Cloud Apps):** additional locations that may be available depending on licensing — **verify availability in your tenant.**

The simulate→enforce journey (the core discipline)

> *Define SITs/classifiers for education records → build each DLP policy in **SIMULATION** (no user impact) → measure hit volume and false positives in **Activity Explorer / DLP alerts** → **tune** (confidence, instance count, keywords, EDM, exceptions) → re-simulate until false positives are acceptable → enable with **policy tips + allow-override/justification** in a **pilot ring** → validate → expand to **enforce (block)** per the FERPA function's action determination → operate (triage alerts, review overrides, re-tune).*

What you can control

• Which SITs/classifiers detect education records and at what **confidence** and **instance count** they trigger (e.g. a single student ID vs a bulk roster).

• Which **locations** each policy covers and which users/sites/groups are **included or excluded** (e.g. the registrar's office may be treated differently from general faculty).

• The **action** per data category (audit → tip → justify → block) — set per the FERPA/registrar determination.

• Whether users get **policy tips**, can **override** with justification, and what the override says.

• The **pilot ring** enforced first and the simulation dwell time before enforcement.

Limitations (be honest with buyers)

• **Endpoint DLP requires onboarded devices and the appropriate licensing** (verify your plan — endpoint DLP and several advanced classifiers are gated behind E5 / the E5 Compliance add-on). A Devices-location policy is inert until onboarding is complete.

• **Some features are in preview** and portal paths **evolve** — this pack flags "verify your licensing/tenant" rather than asserting availability that may differ in your tenant.

• DLP inspects **content it can classify**; strongly encrypted or unrecognized file formats, or content below the confidence/instance threshold, will not match. DLP is one control among several, not a guarantee.

• **The FERPA treatment of any given content — directory vs non-directory, permitted disclosure, enforced action — is a compliance/registrar/legal decision**, not a technical default. This pack configures and proves the control; the determination is deferred.

Naming convention (used in every doc and script)

Every artifact this solution creates uses `<Purpose> – <Scope> – <Stage>`, reused verbatim across the docs, scripts, and the Purview portal. The standard set:

Artifact	Name
Custom sensitive info type (student identifier)	`Student ID – Custom SIT – FERPA`
EDM schema / SIT (SIS records)	`Student Records – EDM – FERPA`
Email DLP policy (simulation)	`DLP – Email Education Records – Simulation`
Cloud DLP policy (simulation)	`DLP – SPO+OneDrive+Teams Education Records – Simulation`
Endpoint DLP policy (simulation)	`DLP – Endpoint Education Records – Simulation`
Enforced pilot policy	`DLP – All Locations Education Records – Enforce Pilot`
Pilot user ring	`FERPA DLP Pilot Ring – Stage1`
Policy-tip / override text	`FERPA DLP Notice – Standard – AllPolicies`
Incident/alert workflow	`FERPA DLP Alerts – Triage – Operations`

The standard deployment model

> ***Assess*** *current education-record exposure and classification intent →* ***Design*** *SITs/classifiers, policies, and user experience →* ***Configure*** *SITs and policies* ***in simulation*** *→* ***Pilot*** *(simulate → tune → enforce to a ring) →* ***Validate*** *against pass/fail gates (records blocked, false-positive rate low, incidents handled) →* ***Expand*** *to the intended scope and ongoing operations. Every high-impact change is piloted in simulation first, with a documented rollback.*

2. Requirements — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview)

These are the **solution-specific** prerequisites for implementing FERPA-aligned education-record DLP across endpoint, cloud, and email. They build on — and do not repeat — the six shared prerequisites in `global-requirements-purview.md` (tenant + compliance licensing, least-privilege Purview roles, S&C PowerShell + Graph toolchain, in-scope data sources, compliance/records/privacy/legal stakeholders, and a pilot scope + change control). Verify each item below before starting the Implementation Guide.

For every requirement: **Description** (what it is), **Why required**, **How to verify**, **How to implement if missing**.

2.1 Licensing sufficient for the DLP features you will use — especially Endpoint DLP

• **Description:** DLP for **Exchange/SharePoint/OneDrive/Teams** and **built-in SITs** is broadly available,

but **Endpoint DLP**, **advanced/custom classifiers**, **Exact Data Match**, and **trainable classifiers** are **plan-gated** — typically **Microsoft 365 E5** or the **E5 Compliance** add-on (some capabilities are in **preview**). Many institutions run **Microsoft 365 A3/A5 (Education)** SKUs; confirm the DLP features you need are included in your specific A-plan. This extends GR-#1 with the DLP-specific plan detail.

• **Why required:** A DLP policy scoped to a location or using a classifier your plan doesn't include will not

function. Endpoint DLP and EDM in particular are E5/E5-Compliance (or A5) capabilities.

• **How to verify:** In the **Microsoft 365 admin center** confirm the subscription/add-ons (A3/A5/E5/E5

Compliance); in the **Purview portal** → **Data Loss Prevention** confirm the **Endpoint DLP** and **Devices** location and the classifier types you intend to use are visible. **Flag "verify your licensing/tenant"** — availability evolves.

• **How to implement if missing:** Acquire/assign the required licensing before building endpoint or

advanced-classifier policies; scope the initial rollout to features your plan covers.

2.2 DLP-specific least-privilege roles

• **Description:** The **DLP role groups** in the Purview portal — **Compliance Administrator** or

Compliance Data Administrator to create/manage DLP policies, **DLP Compliance Management** for policy management, **View-Only DLP Compliance Management** for read-only review, and the **Data Loss Prevention** role for alert/incident handling. Global Administrator only where genuinely required. Extends GR-#2.

- **Why required:** Purview enforces fine-grained role groups; DLP configuration and alert triage require the

matching role, and least privilege keeps the blast radius small — especially important where alert evidence may itself contain student PII.

- **How to verify: Purview portal** → **Settings** → **Roles & scopes** → **Permissions** (or Microsoft Purview

roles) — confirm your account's role-group membership includes the DLP roles you need.

- **How to implement if missing:** Assign the least-privilege DLP role group under change control; separate

policy authors from alert triagers where possible.

2.3 Devices onboarded to Purview for Endpoint DLP

- **Description:** Endpoint DLP monitors activities on **onboarded Windows 10/11 and macOS devices** —

faculty and staff laptops are the endpoints where records are copied to USB, printed, or uploaded. Onboarding is done in **Purview portal** → **Settings** → **Device onboarding** (or via Intune / a script / Group Policy) and is **shared with Microsoft Defender for Endpoint onboarding** — devices already onboarded to Defender for Endpoint are onboarded for Endpoint DLP.

- **Why required:** A DLP policy scoped to the **Devices** location does nothing on a device that is not

onboarded and reporting. Onboarding is the hard prerequisite for any endpoint control.

- **How to verify: Purview portal** → **Settings** → **Device onboarding** → **Devices** shows onboarded devices;

confirm target devices appear and are reporting.

- **How to implement if missing:** Onboard devices via the Purview device-onboarding package, Intune, or

Group Policy; confirm the minimum OS build and any required Antimalware/AV state per Microsoft docs before scoping endpoint policies.

2.4 An education-record classification intent and a student-identifier SIT inventory

- **Description:** A documented view of **which education records and identifiers you are protecting**

(student ID numbers, SSNs, grades/transcripts, disciplinary and counseling records, financial-aid data, and the PII tied to them) mapped to the **SITs/classifiers** that detect them — built-in SITs where they fit (e.g. *U.S. SSN*, *All Full Names*), and a **custom SIT / EDM / trainable classifier** for local student identifiers and record types. Extends GR-#4.

• **Why required:** DLP policies key off SITs; there is no reliable built-in "student ID" detector, so

without a custom SIT tuned to your ID scheme (and knowing at what confidence/instance count it should fire), policies are guesswork and generate false positives.

• **How to verify: Purview portal** → **Data classification** → **Classifiers** → **Sensitive info types** lists

built-in and custom SITs; confirm the ones you need exist (or are planned). Confirm the record categories and identifier formats with the registrar/data owners.

• **How to implement if missing:** Build the SIT inventory (this solution's Discovery script assesses

built-in SIT coverage); plan a `Student ID – Custom SIT – FERPA` and, where near-zero false positives are required, a `Student Records – EDM – FERPA` schema.

2.5 Source data for Exact Data Match (only if EDM is used)

• **Description:** For **EDM** SITs, a **sensitive data table** (e.g. an export of the Student Information

System / records) and a workstation with the **EDM Upload Agent** to hash and upload it — the raw data never leaves your control; only salted hashes are uploaded.

• **Why required:** EDM matches against *your actual student records*, which is what drives false positives

to near zero — but it requires the schema, the hashed upload, and a **refresh cadence** as enrollment changes.

• **How to verify:** Confirm the source table, the EDM schema, the upload agent host, and a scheduled

refresh. **Purview portal** → **Data classification** → **Exact data matches** shows configured EDM schemas.

• **How to implement if missing:** Define the EDM schema and refresh process (*which* fields are in scope is

deferred to the registrar/data owner); if EDM is not in your plan or not needed, use a custom SIT with confidence/keyword tuning instead.

2.6 A pilot ring, simulation dwell time, and change control (DLP-specific)

• **Description:** A named **pilot user/device ring** (`FERPA DLP Pilot Ring – Stage1`), an agreed

simulation dwell time (how long each policy runs in simulation before enforcement — long enough to capture representative traffic, ideally spanning a grading or enrollment cycle), and the **change-control window** for moving simulation → enforce. Extends GR-#6.

• **Why required:** DLP is high-impact in an academic setting where records move constantly during grading

and admissions; enforcing without a simulation baseline and a limited ring is how DLP breaks the business. The house model mandates **simulation first**, then a ring, then expand.

• **How to verify:** Confirm the pilot ring membership, that **simulation mode** is selected on each new

policy, and the approval path to enforce.

• **How to implement if missing:** Define the ring and dwell time and agree change control before enabling

any enforcement action.

2.7 An incident/alert triage owner and destination

• **Description:** A named owner (or queue) for **DLP alerts** raised in **Purview portal → Data loss prevention → Alerts **(`FERPA DLP Alerts – Triage – Operations`**), plus where DLP events are reviewed (**Activity Explorer**) and, optionally, where they are forwarded (SIEM/Microsoft Sentinel via the Office 365 Management Activity API / Defender connectors). Severity and response actions defined. Because alert evidence can contain student PII, the triage owner must hold the appropriate least-privilege role.

• **Why required:** A DLP match with no one to triage it is not a control. Alerts and Activity Explorer are where matches surface; someone must own triage, severity, and response.

• **How to verify:** Confirm the triage owner/queue, the alert-severity scheme, and any SIEM forwarding is configured.

• **How to implement if missing:** Assign the owner, define severity/response, and (optionally) wire SIEM forwarding before enforcement generates real alerts.

Requirements summary

#	Requirement	Gate
GR 1–6	Category prerequisites (`global-requirements-purview.md`)	Tenant/licensing, roles, toolchain, scope, stakeholders, pilot + change control
2.1	DLP/Endpoint licensing (E5 / E5 Compliance / A5; verify)	Endpoint & advanced classifiers available
2.2	DLP least-privilege roles	Author + triage roles assigned
2.3	Devices onboarded to Purview	Endpoint location functional
2.4	Education-record classification intent + student-ID SIT inventory	Policies key off correct SITs
2.5	EDM source data + agent (if used)	Near-zero-FP matching for real records
2.6	Pilot ring + simulation dwell + change control	Simulate-first enforced
2.7	Alert/incident triage owner + destination	Matches are acted on

> ***Deferred to FERPA compliance / registrar / privacy / legal:*** *which records are FERPA-protected, directory vs non-directory treatment, permitted disclosures, the enforced action per category, and regulatory applicability. This solution provides the technical configuration and evidence, not the determination.*

Global Requirements — Microsoft Purview Solutions

These requirements apply to **every** solution in the **Purview** category (implementing and managing Microsoft Purview, sensitivity & retention labels, DLP, data lifecycle & records, insider risk, communication compliance, audit, data security posture management, and data governance). Verify each before starting a solution's implementation steps.

> ***Vendor boundary (applies to every Purview solution).*** *The **Microsoft Purview portal** (purview.microsoft.com), the **Microsoft 365 admin center**, **Security & Compliance PowerShell** (`Connect-IPPSSession`), and **Microsoft Graph** are authored at exact, current click-by-click / cmdlet detail from Microsoft's public documentation. Microsoft Purview features are heavily **licensing-/plan-dependent** (many require **Microsoft 365 E5** or the **E5 Compliance** add-on; some are in preview) and the portal is **actively evolving** — capability availability and portal paths are **cited or flagged "verify your licensing/tenant"**, never asserted or invented. **Regulatory, records-retention, and legal determinations** (retention schedules, records file plans, legal holds, insider-risk case actions, regulatory applicability) are **deferred to the organization's compliance, records, privacy, and legal functions** — the solutions provide the technical configuration method and evidence, not the determination. Automation is **PowerShell** (Security & Compliance PowerShell / Graph) — never with hardcoded credentials or secrets.*

1. Microsoft 365 tenant with the required Purview/compliance licensing

• **Description:** A Microsoft 365 tenant with the **compliance licensing** the capability requires

(E3 for baseline; **E5 / E5 Compliance** for advanced DLP, auto-labeling, insider risk, communication compliance, Audit Premium, DSPM, etc.).

• **Why required:** Most Purview capabilities are plan-gated; the feature won't be available without the

right plan.

• **How to verify:** In the M365 admin center confirm the subscription/add-ons; check the feature is

visible in the Purview portal.

• **How to implement if missing:** Assign/purchase the required licensing before starting.

2. Purview roles (least-privilege) and portal access

• **Description:** Access with the least-privilege **Purview / compliance role** the solution names

(e.g. Compliance Administrator, Compliance Data Administrator, Information Protection, Records Management, Insider Risk, eDiscovery, Audit roles), with Global Administrator only where required.

• **Why required:** Purview uses fine-grained role groups; configuration requires the matching role.

• **How to verify:** Purview portal → **Roles & scopes / Permissions** — confirm the role membership.

• **How to implement if missing:** Assign the least-privilege role group under change control.

3. Security & Compliance PowerShell + Graph toolchain

- **Description:** A workstation with **Security & Compliance PowerShell** (`Connect-IPPSSession` via the

ExchangeOnlineManagement module) and **Microsoft Graph PowerShell**, modern-auth / MFA-capable admin.

- **Why required:** Configuration, automation, and the provided scripts run through these.
- **How to verify:** `Connect-IPPSSession` and `Connect-MgGraph` succeed with the admin account.
- **How to implement if missing:** Install the modules and confirm modern-auth sign-in before running steps.

4. Data sources & scope in scope

- **Description:** The **workloads and data sources** in scope (Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams,

endpoints/devices, and — for data governance — the broader data estate) and a **data-classification / sensitivity** intent to drive labels, DLP, and retention.

- **Why required:** Purview policies key off the in-scope workloads and the classification scheme.
- **How to verify:** Confirm the in-scope workloads and the classification/sensitivity approach with

stakeholders.

- **How to implement if missing:** Define the scope and classification intent before authoring policies.

5. Compliance, records, privacy & legal stakeholders

- **Description:** Engagement with the **compliance, records-management, privacy, security, and legal**

stakeholders whose policies the configuration must satisfy (retention schedules, records file plans, regulatory obligations, insider-risk and communication-compliance policy, legal hold).

- **Why required:** Purview configuration must align to enterprise policy and legal/records requirements,

not technical defaults; several capabilities have HR/legal sensitivity.

- **How to verify:** Confirm the applicable policies, the records schedule, and named approvers.
- **How to implement if missing:** Identify the owners and capture the requirements before configuring.

6. A pilot scope and change control

- **Description:** A **pilot scope** (users/sites/policies in simulation or a limited ring) to validate

on before tenant-wide enforcement, and a **change-control** process — most Purview policies support a **simulation / test / disabled** mode that MUST be used before enforcement.

- **Why required:** Every solution follows an **Assess → Design → Configure → Pilot (simulate) → Validate

→ Expand (enforce)** model; DLP, labels, retention, and insider-risk changes are high-impact.

- **How to verify:** Confirm a named pilot scope, that simulation/test mode is available, and a change

window/approval path.

- **How to implement if missing:** Define the pilot and agree change control before enforcing anything.

*The deployment model across every Purview solution is the same: **Assess** → **Design** → **Configure** → **Pilot (simulate/test)** → **Validate** → **Expand (enforce)**, with explicit pass/fail gates and a documented rollback. Automation is delivered as **PowerShell** (Security & Compliance PowerShell / Graph) — never with hardcoded credentials or secrets. Regulatory/records/legal determinations are deferred to the relevant governance functions.*

3. Implementation Guide — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview)

This is the exact, ordered procedure to implement FERPA-aligned education-record DLP across **email, cloud, Teams, and endpoint** — every policy built in **SIMULATION** first, tuned, then enforced in a ring, then expanded. Portal paths and cmdlets are from Microsoft's public documentation; **licensing-/plan-dependent features and evolving portal paths are flagged "verify your licensing/tenant"** and are never asserted for your tenant. Do the phases in order. Each phase names its artifacts (from the Overview naming table), states a **pass/fail gate**, and gives a **rollback**.

> ***Automation.*** *The five delivered PowerShell tools run through **Security & Compliance PowerShell** (`Connect-IPPSSession`) and **Microsoft Graph**. They are **read-only or** `-WhatIf` **by default**; writes require an explicit `-Commit` switch. No credentials are stored in code.*
>
> ***Determinations deferred.*** **Which* records are FERPA-protected, **directory vs non-directory** treatment, which disclosures are permitted, and the *enforced action* per category are **FERPA-compliance / registrar / privacy / legal** decisions. This guide configures and proves the control; capture those decisions before Phase 3.*

Phase 0 — Connect and baseline (Assess)

1. **Connect the toolchain** (GR-#3). On the admin workstation:

```
Install-Module ExchangeOnlineManagement -Scope CurrentUser -Force   # provides Connect-IPPSSession
Connect-IPPSSession -UserPrincipalName admin@contoso.com            # Security & Compliance PowerShell
Connect-MgGraph -Scopes 'Organization.Read.All','InformationProtectionPolicy.Read' -NoWelcome
```

1. **Run the posture assessment** (delivered script #1, read-only):

```
.\DLPFERPA-Discovery.ps1 -CsvPath .\DLPFERPA-Posture.csv
```

It reports existing DLP policies and their mode, built-in vs custom SIT coverage (including whether a student-identifier custom SIT already exists), and licensing/endpoint readiness signals.

1. **Confirm licensing and endpoint readiness** (Req 2.1, 2.3): confirm E5/E5-Compliance/A5 where endpoint or

advanced classifiers are needed, and that target faculty/staff devices are **onboarded**.

Pass/fail gate: you have a written baseline (existing policies + modes), a SIT coverage map for education records, and confirmed licensing + endpoint onboarding for the locations you will target. **Rollback:** none (read-only).

Phase 1 — Design the classification layer (SITs & classifiers for education records)

Decide, per in-scope record category, which detector applies. Do **not** invent SITs — use built-in where they fit; build custom/EDM/trainable only for gaps. *Whether a regulatory (e.g. FERPA-labeled) DLP policy template is available is version-/licensing-dependent — check the template gallery, but do not rely on one existing.*

1. **Map built-in SITs first.** In **Purview portal → Data classification → Classifiers → Sensitive info types**, confirm the built-in SITs for your categories — e.g. *U.S. Social Security Number (SSN)*, *All Full Names*, *U.S. Physical Addresses*, *U.S. Bank Account Number* (for financial-aid data). Note each SIT's** confidence levels **and default** instance count**.

1. **Author a custom SIT for the student identifier.** Student IDs are institution-specific, so create `Student ID – Custom SIT – FERPA` with a **regex primary pattern** matched to your ID format, **supporting keywords** (e.g. "student ID", "student number", "SIS ID"), a **confidence level**, and a **character proximity**. Portal: **Classifiers → Sensitive info types → Create sensitive info type**. Test it against sample text in the wizard's **Test** step with fabricated IDs.

1. **Configure EDM where near-zero false positives are required** (Req 2.5). Define the schema (`Student Records – EDM – FERPA`), hash-and-upload the SIS/records export with the **EDM Upload Agent**, and set a **refresh cadence** tied to enrollment changes. Portal: **Data classification → Exact data matches**. *Which fields are in scope is the registrar/data owner's determination.*

1. **Add trainable classifiers where a category is conceptual, not pattern-based** (e.g. transcripts, disciplinary letters) — use a built-in trainable classifier where one fits, or train a custom one on sample content. Verify availability against your plan.

Pass/fail gate: every in-scope record category maps to a named, tested SIT/classifier at a chosen confidence and instance count; the student-ID custom SIT matches fabricated IDs and does not match unrelated numbers. **Rollback:** delete unused custom SITs/EDM schemas (they have no effect until referenced by a policy).

Phase 2 — Build the DLP policies in SIMULATION (Configure — no user impact)

Create **one policy per location group**, each in **simulation mode**. Simulation evaluates the policy against real traffic and records what *would* match, with **no** enforcement and (optionally) with policy tips shown.

1. **Email DLP policy —** `DLP – Email Education Records – Simulation`**.**

Portal: **Data loss prevention → Policies → Create policy** → custom (or a regulatory template if one applies in your tenant) → **Locations: Exchange email only** → rule: condition *Content contains* the education-record SITs from Phase 1 (Student ID SIT, SSN, and/or the EDM SIT) at the chosen confidence/instance count → action *Restrict access or encrypt* (kept inert by simulation) → **Policy mode: Run the policy in simulation mode** (optionally *with policy tips*). Finish.

1. **Cloud DLP policy —** `DLP – SPO+OneDrive+Teams Education Records – Simulation`**.**

Same flow → **Locations: SharePoint sites, OneDrive accounts, Teams chat and channel messages** → conditions as above → action *Restrict access* (block external sharing on match) → **simulation mode**.

1. **Endpoint DLP policy —** `DLP – Endpoint Education Records – Simulation` (requires onboarded devices +

licensing). Same flow → **Locations: Devices** → conditions as above → **endpoint activities to audit/restrict**: *copy to USB/removable media*, *copy to network share*, *print*, *upload to unallowed cloud apps/browser*, *copy to clipboard*, *paste to browser* → **simulation mode**. Confirm the Devices location is selectable (if not, revisit licensing/onboarding — Req 2.1/2.3).

1. **Set the user experience** consistently: define `FERPA DLP Notice – Standard – AllPolicies` policy-tip

text (in plain academic language — *why* this was flagged and *what to do*) and enable **allow override with justification** where the FERPA/registrar function permits — but note tips/overrides only *appear* once a policy is enforced; in simulation they are captured, not shown to end users unless "simulation with policy tips" is selected.

1. **Verify with the config helper** (delivered script #2, `-WhatIf` by default):

```
.\DLPFERPA-Config.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' `
    -Locations Exchange -SensitiveTypes 'Student ID - Custom SIT - FERPA' -MinCount 5 -Confidence High
```

Run with `-Commit` only to apply an intended change; the script never leaves a policy in enforce mode.

Pass/fail gate: all three policies exist and are confirmed in **simulation** (script #1/#2 report `Mode = TestWithoutNotifications / TestWithNotifications`, i.e. simulation), scoped to the correct locations and education-record SITs. **Rollback:** delete the simulation policy — simulation has no user impact, so removal is clean.

Phase 3 — Measure and tune (drive false positives down)

Let each policy run in simulation for the agreed **dwell time** (Req 2.6) to capture representative academic traffic (grading, admissions, registrar operations).

1. **Review what matched. Purview portal** → **Data loss prevention** → **Alerts** (simulation alerts) and

Data classification → **Activity explorer** (filter to DLP activities) show every simulated match with the file/message, the SIT, and the confidence. Export with the reporting script:

```
.\DLPFERPA-Report.ps1 -Days 14 -CsvPath .\DLPFERPA-Matches.csv
```

1. **Classify each match** as true positive or **false positive** and identify the false-positive drivers

(e.g. the Student ID SIT firing on unrelated 8-digit numbers, or a name-and-address match on **directory information** the registrar has deemed disclosable — a treatment decision, not a detector fault).

1. **Tune** to reduce false positives without losing true positives:

• Raise the **confidence level** (e.g. medium → high) so only high-confidence matches count.

• Raise the **instance count** (e.g. require ≥5 student IDs, not 1) to focus on bulk-roster leaks.

• Add **supporting keywords / proximity** to the Student ID custom SIT so context is required.

• Introduce **EDM** (`Student Records – EDM – FERPA`) for categories where pattern SITs over-match.

• Add **exceptions** (e.g. exclude a registrar mailbox/site the FERPA function has scoped out) where justified.

1. **Re-simulate** after each tuning change and re-measure. Repeat until the false-positive rate meets the validation gate (see Testing).

Pass/fail gate: measured false-positive rate is at/under the agreed threshold on the simulation sample, with true positives (real education-record leaks) still detected. **Rollback:** revert the last tuning change (script #2 `-WhatIf` shows the diff before `-Commit`).

Phase 4 — Enforce in a pilot ring (Pilot)

1. **Scope to the pilot ring.** Add `FERPA DLP Pilot Ring – Stage1` (users) and pilot devices as the **included** scope on each policy (all other users/devices excluded for now):

```
.\DLPFERPA-Set-Scope.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' `
    -PilotRingGroup 'FERPADLPPilotRing@contoso.com' -Location Exchange -Commit
```

1. **Move the ring to enforcement.** Change **Policy mode** from *simulation* to **Turn it on / Enforce**.

Start with **policy tips + allow-override (justification)** rather than hard block, so pilot staff can report false negatives/positives while retaining a business escape hatch for legitimate record handling.

1. **Confirm enforcement is live** for the ring only (script #1 reports mode `Enable` and the scoped identities). Confirm end users in the ring now see the `FERPA DLP Notice – Standard – AllPolicies` tip on a test match (fabricated data).

1. **Handle incidents.** Wire `FERPA DLP Alerts – Triage – Operations`: assign the alert owner/queue (Req 2.7), set severities, and (optionally) forward to SIEM/Sentinel. Triage a real simulated/pilot alert end-to-end to prove the workflow — and confirm alert evidence is only accessible to appropriately-roled staff.

Pass/fail gate: the pilot ring is enforced (tips shown, overrides captured), matches raise alerts, and the triage workflow produces a dispositioned incident. No enforcement outside the ring. **Rollback:** set the policy back to **simulation mode** (single setting) — instantly removes enforcement with no data change.

Phase 5 — Expand and harden (Enforce → Operate)

1. **Expand scope** from the ring to the full intended population once the pilot gate passes, keeping documented exclusions (e.g. the registrar's office if scoped differently by the FERPA function).

1. **Escalate the action** per the FERPA/registrar determination — e.g. move a category from *tip + override* to **block** where required (external sharing of non-directory records) — one category/location at a time, re-validating after each.

1. **Operationalize:** schedule the reporting script for a recurring false-positive/alert review, review **user overrides** (are staff justifying legitimately or bypassing?), refresh **EDM** data on cadence as enrollment changes, and re-tune as data and behavior change.
1. **Validate end-to-end** with the delivered testing procedure (next section) and record the pass/fail evidence.

Pass/fail gate: enforcement live across the intended scope with the FERPA-mandated action per category; false-positive rate steady/low; alerts triaged on cadence; overrides reviewed. **Rollback:** any policy can be returned to **simulation** at any time as an immediate, non-destructive safety switch; individual policies can be disabled without affecting others.

Order-of-operations summary

Phase	Do	Artifact(s)	Gate	Rollback
0 Assess	Connect, baseline, confirm licensing/onboarding	Posture CSV	Baseline + readiness confirmed	n/a (read-only)
1 Design	Map built-in SITs, build Student ID SIT / EDM / classifiers	Custom SIT / EDM schema	Every category → tested detector	Delete unused SIT/EDM
2 Configure	Build 3 policies in **simulation**	Email/Cloud/Endpoint sim policies	All in simulation, correct scope	Delete sim policy
3 Tune	Measure + reduce false positives	Matches CSV	FP rate ≤ threshold	Revert tuning change
4 Pilot	Enforce to ring, wire alerts	Pilot ring, alert triage	Ring enforced, incident dispositioned	Back to simulation
5 Expand	Broaden scope, escalate to block, operate	Enforced policies	Full-scope enforce, low FP, alerts triaged	Simulation / disable

5. Testing & Validation — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview)

Validate the education-record DLP implementation against explicit **pass/fail gates**. The three headline gates are: **(A) record leaks are blocked**, **(B) the false-positive rate is low**, and **(C) incidents are handled**. Run every test with **non-real, clearly-fake sample data** — fabricated student IDs, the Microsoft-documented test SSN pattern, and dummy names — **never real student records or PII**. Record the evidence.

> *All tests assume the policies from the Implementation Guide, first proven in **simulation** and then enforced to the **pilot ring**. Endpoint tests require an **onboarded** device (Req 2.3).*

Test A — Detection & enforcement (record leaks are blocked)

#	Test	Steps	Pass condition
A1	Email match blocked	From a pilot-ring user, send an email to an **external** recipient containing a fabricated roster with enough fake student IDs/SSNs to meet the threshold.	Message is blocked/encrypted per the enforced action; sender sees the policy tip; a DLP alert is raised.
A2	SharePoint/OneDrive external share blocked	As a ring user, upload a fake gradebook with the education-record SIT and attempt to share it **externally**.	External sharing is blocked/restricted on match; event appears in Activity Explorer.
A3	Teams message match	Paste fabricated student-ID/record content into a Teams chat/channel covered by the policy.	Message is blocked or tipped per the enforced action; event logged.
A4	Endpoint — USB copy	On an onboarded ring device, copy a fake records file to **removable media**.	Activity is audited/blocked per policy; endpoint DLP event appears in Activity Explorer.
A5	Endpoint — print / cloud upload	On the ring device, attempt to **print** the fake records file and **upload** it to an unallowed cloud app/browser.	Each activity is audited/restricted per policy; events logged.
A6	Below-threshold negative	Send content with **fewer** student IDs than the threshold (or lower confidence).	Correctly **not** matched — confirms the threshold/confidence tuning holds.

Gate A (pass): A1–A5 each produce the enforced action and a logged event; A6 correctly does not match.

Test B — False-positive rate (adoption gate)

#	Test	Steps	Pass condition
B1	Simulation FP baseline	Over the agreed dwell time, export simulation matches (`DLPFERPA-Report.ps1 -Days <n>`) and classify each as TP/FP.	**False-positive rate** ≤ **the agreed threshold** (define with the FERPA function; a common target is ≤10% of matches, or an absolute FP count the triage team can absorb).
B2	Legitimate-traffic negative	Run representative legitimate academic content (no real student data) through the covered channels — internal course materials, reference numbers, non-record documents.	Legitimate traffic is **not** matched — no spurious tips/blocks.
B3	Student-ID SIT precision	Send documents containing unrelated numbers with the same digit length as a student ID but no supporting keywords.	The `Student ID – Custom SIT – FERPA` does **not** fire without its keyword/proximity context.
B4	Post-tuning re-measure	After each tuning change (confidence↑, instance count↑, keywords, EDM, exceptions), re-simulate and re-measure.	FP rate trends **down** while true positives (Test A) still fire.
B5	Override sanity	In the pilot ring, review captured **allow-with-justification** overrides.	Overrides are legitimate academic/administrative justifications, not routine bypass — if routine, re-tune or re-scope.

Gate B (pass): measured FP rate at/under threshold on the simulation sample with true positives intact.

Test C — Incident / alert handling (the control is operable)

#	Test	Steps	Pass condition
C1	Alert raised	Trigger a policy match (Test A1/A4).	A DLP **alert** appears in **Purview** → **Data loss prevention** → **Alerts** with the correct policy, severity, and evidence.

#	Test	Steps	Pass condition
C2	Triage workflow	The `FERPA DLP Alerts – Triage – Operations` owner/queue picks up the alert, sets status, and dispositions it.	Alert moves through the defined states to a resolved disposition by the named owner.
C3	Activity Explorer trail	Locate the same event in **Data classification** → **Activity explorer**.	Full evidence trail present (user, location, SIT, action) for investigation.
C4	Evidence access control	Confirm who can view the alert evidence (which may contain student PII).	Only appropriately-roled staff can view; least-privilege holds (Req 2.2/2.7).
C5	SIEM forwarding (if configured)	Confirm the DLP event reaches the SIEM/Sentinel destination (Req 2.7).	Event present in the downstream system with usable fields.

Gate C (pass): matches raise alerts, alerts are triaged to disposition by the owner with least-privilege evidence access, and the trail (and SIEM forward, if used) is present.

Simulation-first & rollback validation

#	Test	Pass condition
S1	Nothing enforced outside the ring	Users/devices **outside** `FERPA DLP Pilot Ring – Stage1` experience no blocking during pilot.
S2	Instant rollback	Setting any enforced policy back to **simulation mode** immediately removes enforcement with no data change (verify a previously-blocked action now only simulates).
S3	Scripts are safe-by-default	`DLPFERPA-Config.ps1` and `DLPFERPA-Set-Scope.ps1` run **without** `-Commit` make no change (`-WhatIf` output only); discovery/validate/report scripts are read-only.

Evidence to capture (for the deliverable record)

- Baseline posture CSV (Phase 0) and the education-record SIT coverage map.

• Simulation match export + TP/FP classification and the computed **false-positive rate** before/after

tuning (Gate B).

• Screenshots/log of Test A enforcement actions and the raised alerts (Gate A/C).

• The dispositioned incident from Test C2, the evidence-access confirmation (C4), and, if used, the SIEM

forward (C5).

• Confirmation that outside-ring users were unaffected (S1) and that simulation rollback works (S2).

> ***Determination boundary.*** *These tests prove the* ***control works****. Whether a given record category's enforced action, its directory-vs-non-directory treatment, and the acceptable FP threshold are *acceptable* is a FERPA-compliance/registrar/legal sign-off, captured alongside the evidence above.*

6. Troubleshooting — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview)

Symptom-first fixes for the failures you actually hit implementing education-record DLP across email, cloud, Teams, and endpoint. Most problems are one of: a policy not matching, the student-ID SIT not firing, the endpoint location unavailable, too many false positives, or matches that raise no alert.

Policy / detection

A DLP policy matches nothing even though the content clearly contains education records.

• Confirm the policy is actually **enabled and in a mode that evaluates** — a *disabled* policy does nothing;

a **simulation** policy evaluates and logs but does not block. Check with `DLPFERPA-Discovery.ps1` (Mode column) or `DLPFERPA-Validate.ps1`.

• Check the **instance count and confidence** on the rule — if it requires ≥5 student IDs at High confidence

and your test has 1, it correctly won't fire. Lower the threshold for testing, or add more sample instances.

• **Policy propagation takes time** — newly created/changed DLP policies can take **up to ~1 hour (and longer

for some locations)** to take effect. Wait before concluding it's broken.

• Confirm the **location scope** includes where you're testing (e.g. the specific site/user), and that the

test identity isn't in an **exclusion** (e.g. a registrar mailbox the FERPA function scoped out).

The `Student ID – Custom SIT – FERPA` **never matches.**

• Test the SIT's **regex + keywords** in the SIT wizard's **Test** step with a fabricated ID that matches

your format. A too-strict regex, wrong **character proximity**, or a required keyword that isn't present will suppress all matches. Loosen and re-test incrementally.

• If it matches *too much* (e.g. every 8-digit number), that's a precision problem, not a miss — add/require

supporting keywords ("student ID", "SIS ID") and tighten proximity (see False positives below).

Matches appear in simulation but nothing is blocked.

- That is **correct** — simulation logs what *would* happen without enforcing. To block, move the policy to

enforce for the pilot ring (Implementation Phase 4). If you expected blocking, you're still in simulation.

A name-and-address match looks like a false positive but the registrar says it's fine.

- That may be **directory information** the FERPA/registrar function has deemed disclosable — a *treatment*

decision, not a detector fault. Don't weaken the detector; implement the agreed exception as a documented scope exclusion, and record the FERPA sign-off.

Endpoint DLP

The Devices/Endpoint location isn't available when creating a policy.

- **Licensing:** Endpoint DLP requires the appropriate plan (E5 / E5 Compliance / A5) — check the licensing

signal with `DLPFERPA-Validate.ps1` and **verify in the admin center**.

- **Onboarding:** the Devices location depends on **onboarded devices** — confirm in **Purview portal → Settings → Device onboarding**. No onboarded devices → the location does nothing even if selectable.

Endpoint policy is enforced but device activities (USB/print/upload) aren't caught.

- Confirm the specific **device is onboarded and reporting** (portal device list), meets the **minimum OS

build**, and — for some activities — that the required agent/AV prerequisites per Microsoft docs are met.

- Confirm the **activity is in scope** of the rule (e.g. "copy to USB" is enabled) and that the app/browser or network path isn't on an **allowed/exception** list (e.g. a sanctioned SIS/LMS tool).

- Allow for **reporting latency** — endpoint events can take time to surface in Activity Explorer.

False positives (the adoption killer)

Faculty/staff are getting policy tips on legitimate, non-record content.

- Export matches with `DLPFERPA-Report.ps1 -CsvPath ...`, classify TP/FP, and identify the driver.

- **Raise confidence** (medium→high) and/or **instance count** (a single ID is often legitimate; a roster is a leak) so low-signal hits don't fire.

- Add **supporting keywords/proximity** to the Student ID custom SIT so context is required, not just a number pattern.

- For a built-in SIT (or a pattern SIT) that over-matches your identifiers, move that category to **Exact

Data Match** (`Student Records – EDM – FERPA`) so only your real enrolled records match.

- Add a targeted **exception** where the FERPA function has justified it (specific mailbox/site) — narrowly,

with a documented reason.

- Re-simulate after each change and re-measure — don't stack multiple changes blind.

Alerts / incident handling

Policy matches occur but no alert appears / no one is notified.

- Confirm **alerts are configured** on the rule (alert on match, threshold) and check **Purview → Data loss

prevention → Alerts**. Some low-severity matches aggregate rather than alert per event.

- Confirm **audit logging is enabled** in the tenant — the report script and Activity Explorer rely on it.

- Confirm the **triage owner/queue** (`FERPA DLP Alerts – Triage – Operations`) exists and, if forwarding to

SIEM/Sentinel, that the connector is healthy (Req 2.7).

Triage staff can't see the alert evidence (or see too much).

- Alert evidence can contain student PII — access is governed by **role**. Confirm the triage owner holds the

least-privilege **Data Loss Prevention / View-Only DLP** role and nothing broader (Req 2.2/2.7).

The report script returns no matches.

- **Audit log latency:** DLP events can take time to appear; widen `-Days` and re-run.
- Freshly created policies need **dwell time** — there may simply be no matches yet.
- Confirm **audit logging is on** and your account has the **View-Only DLP / audit** role.

Connectivity / tooling

`Connect-IPPSSession` **or a DLP cmdlet fails.**

- Ensure the **ExchangeOnlineManagement** module is installed/updated and you're using a **modern-auth /

MFA-capable** admin.

- Confirm the account holds the required **DLP role** (Compliance Administrator / Compliance Data

Administrator / DLP Compliance Management) — a missing role surfaces as "cmdlet not recognized" or access denied.

A script made an unexpected change.

- The delivered scripts are **read-only or** `-WhatIf` **by default**; writes require `-Commit`. If a change

landed, it was committed intentionally — the config helper never leaves a policy in **enforce**, so the safe recovery is always to set the policy back to **simulation** in the portal (one setting, no data change).

Fast triage table

Symptom	First check
Policy matches nothing	Mode (disabled/sim), instance count/confidence, propagation time, scope/exclusion
Student ID SIT never fires	Test regex+keywords+proximity in the SIT wizard
Student ID SIT over-matches	Require supporting keywords, tighten proximity, or move to EDM
Nothing blocked	Still in **simulation** — that's expected; enforce the ring to block
"False positive" on name/address	May be **directory information** — a registrar/FERPA treatment call, not a detector fault
Devices location missing	Licensing (E5/E5 Compliance/A5) + device **onboarding**
Endpoint activity not caught	Device onboarded/reporting, activity in scope, allowed-app/network exceptions
Too many false positives	Raise confidence/instance count, add keywords/EDM, exceptions, re-simulate
No alert on match	Alert config on rule, audit logging on, triage owner, SIEM connector
Evidence access wrong	Least-privilege DLP role on the triage owner
Report returns nothing	Audit latency/dwell time, audit logging on, role
Cmdlet/connect fails	Module updated, modern auth, correct DLP role

7. Best Practices — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview)

Field-tested practices for running education-record DLP across endpoint, cloud, and email so the control stays trusted, effective, and low-noise in an academic environment. These complement the Implementation and Testing guides.

Simulate before you enforce — always

• **Never** switch a new or materially changed DLP policy straight to enforce. Run it in **simulation** first, long enough to capture representative academic traffic (a grading or admissions cycle is ideal — Req 2.6), and read the results before enabling.

• Use **simulation with policy tips** on the pilot ring when you want faculty/staff feedback before hard block.

• Treat **simulation mode as your permanent safety switch**: any enforced policy can be returned to simulation in one setting, instantly removing enforcement with no data change — this is your rollback.

Get the student-identifier classification right

- **There is no reliable built-in student-ID detector** — build `Student ID – Custom SIT – FERPA` tuned to

your local ID format, with **supporting keywords and proximity** so a bare number doesn't fire.

- Use **Exact Data Match** (`Student Records – EDM – FERPA`) for categories where pattern SITs over-fire — it

matches your *actual* enrolled records and drives false positives toward zero, at the cost of an upload + refresh cadence tied to enrollment.

- **Reuse built-in SITs** (SSN, names, addresses, bank account) wherever they fit; build custom/EDM/trainable

only for genuine gaps — fewer, well-tuned detectors beat a sprawl of overlapping ones.

Tune for a low false-positive rate (adoption depends on it)

- Start at **higher confidence** and a **realistic instance count** — a single student ID is often

legitimate; a roster of them in one outbound file is a leak. Bulk-exfiltration thresholds cut false positives dramatically.

- Every false positive that reaches a faculty member erodes trust in **every** policy tip. Budget for a

tuning cycle, not a one-time build.

- Re-simulate after each change and re-measure — don't stack multiple tuning changes blind.

Respect the directory-vs-non-directory boundary

- **DLP detects content; the registrar/FERPA function decides treatment.** The same name-and-address content

may be disclosable **directory information** for one student and protected for another who has opted out. Don't encode a FERPA determination into a detector — scope and action follow the compliance decision.

- Where the FERPA function scopes a mailbox/site out (e.g. the registrar's controlled disclosure workflow),

implement it as a **documented exception**, not a silently weakened policy.

Right-size the user experience

- Show **clear, actionable policy tips** in plain academic language — tell the user *why* and *what to do*,

not a compliance error code. Reuse one standard notice (`FERPA DLP Notice – Standard – AllPolicies`).

- Prefer **allow-with-justification / override** over hard block for categories where legitimate academic

exceptions exist, then **review the overrides** — routine overriding means the policy is mis-scoped.

• Reserve **hard block** for the categories where the FERPA function requires it (e.g. external sharing of non-directory records); escalate to block one category at a time, re-validating each.

Endpoint DLP specifics

• **Onboarding is the gate.** A Devices policy is inert until the faculty/staff device is onboarded (shared with Defender for Endpoint) and reporting — verify onboarding before blaming the policy.

• Roll endpoint controls out **audit-first**: audit USB/print/cloud-upload activities before restricting, so you see real record-handling patterns and avoid blocking legitimate academic workflows.

• Mind **unallowed vs allowed apps/browsers and network exceptions** — configure the allowed-app and network-path lists so sanctioned SIS/LMS tools aren't caught alongside exfiltration paths.

Operations & governance

• Give DLP **alerts an owner and an SLA** (Req 2.7). Match volume without triage is not a control. Forward to SIEM/Sentinel where central SecOps needs visibility — but keep evidence access least-privilege since it can contain student PII.

• Review **Activity Explorer** and the false-positive rate on a **recurring cadence**; re-tune as data and behavior drift across terms.

• Enforce **least-privilege roles** and, where possible, **separate policy authors from alert triagers**.

• **Refresh EDM data** on a schedule aligned to enrollment — stale EDM data silently degrades matching.

• Keep a **change log** of every simulate→enforce transition and every action escalation, with the FERPA/registrar sign-off attached.

Stay inside the boundary

• DLP is **one control**, not a guarantee — it inspects content it can classify; combine with sensitivity labels, encryption, and insider-risk where the risk warrants.

• **Verify licensing/tenant** before relying on any endpoint or advanced-classifier capability, and before assuming a FERPA-labeled policy template exists — plans and portal paths evolve; don't assume a feature is present.

• The **FERPA treatment, the enforced action, and the acceptable false-positive threshold per category are compliance/registrar/legal determinations** — you provide the technical control and the evidence; they own the decision.

8. Deliverables Summary — FERPA DLP Pack (Microsoft Purview)

What you receive in this solution, and what "done" looks like.

Documentation

Document	What it gives you
Solution Overview	The education-record DLP model — SITs/classifiers (including the Student ID custom SIT and EDM), the five locations (email, SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams, endpoint), policy tips/overrides, the directory-vs-non-directory boundary, and the simulate→enforce journey; naming convention.
Requirements Guide	Solution-specific prerequisites (DLP/Endpoint licensing incl. A3/A5, DLP roles, device onboarding, education-record classification intent + student-ID SIT inventory, EDM source data, pilot ring, alert triage owner) each with verify/implement steps, on top of the six category prerequisites.
Implementation Guide	The exact ordered phases: connect/baseline → design education-record SITs → build policies **in simulation** → tune false positives → enforce to a pilot ring → expand; each phase named, gated, and with a rollback.
Testing & Validation	Pass/fail gates for the three headline outcomes — record leaks blocked (A), low false-positive rate (B), incidents handled (C) — plus student-ID precision, evidence-access, simulation-first and rollback checks, all with fabricated test data.
Troubleshooting Guide	The common failure modes (policy not matching, student-ID SIT never fires, endpoint location missing, floods of false positives, no alerts) and how to resolve them.
Best Practices	Simulate-first discipline, student-identifier classification, false-positive tuning, the directory/non-directory boundary, user-experience design, endpoint specifics, and operations/governance.
Executive Summary	One-page business framing for approvers.

PowerShell tools (5) — Security & Compliance PowerShell / Graph

All tools are **read-only or `-WhatIf` by default**; writes require an explicit `-Commit`. No credentials are stored in code. They connect via `Connect-IPPSSession` and/or `Connect-MgGraph`.

#	Script	Role	Default safety
1	**DLPFERPA-Discovery.ps1**	DLP posture + education-record SIT coverage assessment: existing policies and their mode, built-in vs custom SIT coverage (incl. whether a student-ID SIT exists), licensing/endpoint readiness signals.	Read-only
2	**DLPFERPA-Config.ps1**	DLP policy configuration/remediation helper: creates/updates an education-record policy **in simulation mode** and reports the intended change.	`-WhatIf` (writes need `-Commit`; never leaves a policy in enforce)
3	**DLPFERPA-Validate.ps1**	Validation checker: confirms the FERPA policy set is in simulation, scoped to the correct locations/SITs, and (optionally) checks endpoint-location/onboarding readiness — reports pass/fail per gate.	Read-only
4	**DLPFERPA-Report.ps1**	DLP match / false-positive tuning report: exports simulation/enforcement matches for TP-vs-FP classification and rate calculation.	Read-only
5	**DLPFERPA-Set-Scope.ps1**	Scope/health helper: reports a policy's locations/mode/scope and (with `-Commit`) adjusts the included/excluded users/groups (e.g. the pilot ring).	`-WhatIf` (writes need `-Commit`)

Definition of done

• Education-record SITs/classifiers mapped for every in-scope category (built-in reused; `Student ID – Custom

SIT – FERPA `and, where needed,` Student Records – EDM – FERPA` for gaps).

• Email, cloud (SPO/OneDrive/Teams), and endpoint DLP policies built and **proven in simulation**.

• False-positive rate measured and tuned to at/under the agreed threshold (Gate B), with student-ID precision

confirmed.

• Enforcement live for the pilot ring with policy tips + override, then expanded per the FERPA function's

action determination (Gate A).

• DLP alerts raised, triaged to disposition with least-privilege evidence access, and evidence trailed in

Activity Explorer (Gate C).

• Simulation-rollback and safe-by-default scripts verified; change log and FERPA/registrar sign-offs captured.

> ***Boundary:*** *the solution delivers the technical control and the evidence. The* ***records in scope, the directory-vs-non-directory treatment, the classifiers that legally apply, the enforced action per category, and the acceptable false-positive threshold*** *are FERPA-compliance/registrar/privacy/legal determinations, captured alongside the evidence.*

Appendix A — PowerShell Scripts

Included in the accompanying ZIP. Each script's header documents full usage.

DLPFERPA-Config.ps1

Purpose: Creates a new DLP compliance policy (and a matching content rule for one or more education-record sensitive information types — e.g. the Student ID custom SIT, U.S. SSN, or an EDM SIT) in SIMULATION mode, or updates an existing policy's rule, across the chosen locations (Exchange / SharePoint / OneDrive / Teams / Endpoint). Safe by default: with -WhatIf it only reports the intended change; it applies nothing unless -Commit is passed, and it NEVER creates or leaves a policy in enforce (Enable) mode — simulation only. Enforcement is a deliberate, separate portal/change-control step (a FERPA/registrar action determination). HOW TO RUN Preview an Exchange simulation policy for the Student ID custom SIT: powershell -File .\DLPFERPA-Config.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' `-Locations Exchange -SensitiveTypes 'Student ID - Custom SIT - FERPA' -MinCount 5 -Confidence High -WhatIf Actually create it (still simulation mode): powershell -File .\DLPFERPA-Config.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation'` -Locations Exchange -SensitiveTypes 'Student ID - Custom SIT - FERPA' -MinCount 5 -Confidence High -Commit Requires Security & Compliance PowerShell (Connect-IPPSSession). .EXAMPLE .\DLPFERPA-Config.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' -Locations Exchange -WhatIf Prints the New-DlpCompliancePolicy / New-DlpComplianceRule calls it WOULD run, with Mode=TestWithNotifications. .NOTES Purview — FERPA DLP Pack. Writes gated behind -Commit; simulation-only (never Enable). No credentials in code. Expected results: -Commit creates the policy in simulation; verify a Test* Mode with DLPFERPA-Discovery.ps1 (PASS). > [CmdletBinding()] param([Parameter(Mandatory)][string]$PolicyName, [ValidateSet('Exchange','SharePoint','OneDrive','Teams','Endpoint')] [string[]]$Locations = @('Exchange'), [string[]]$SensitiveTypes = @('Student ID - Custom SIT - FERPA'), [int]$MinCount = 5, [ValidateSet('Low','Medium','High')][string]$Confidence = 'High', Simulation flavour: with or without showing policy tips to users during the test. [ValidateSet('TestWithNotifications','TestWithoutNotifications')][string]$SimulationMode = 'TestWithNotifications', [string]$UserPrincipalName, [switch]$Commit)

How to run: Preview an Exchange simulation policy for the Student ID custom SIT: powershell -File .\DLPFERPA-Config.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' `-Locations Exchange -SensitiveTypes 'Student ID - Custom SIT - FERPA' -MinCount 5 -Confidence High -WhatIf Actually create it (still simulation mode): powershell -File .\DLPFERPA-Config.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation'` -Locations Exchange -SensitiveTypes 'Student ID - Custom SIT - FERPA' -MinCount 5 -Confidence High -Commit Requires Security & Compliance PowerShell (Connect-IPPSSession). .EXAMPLE .\DLPFERPA-Config.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' -Locations Exchange -WhatIf Prints the New-DlpCompliancePolicy / New-DlpComplianceRule calls it WOULD run, with Mode=TestWithNotifications. .NOTES Purview — FERPA DLP Pack. Writes gated behind -Commit; simulation-only (never Enable). No credentials in code. Expected results: -Commit creates the policy in simulation; verify a Test* Mode with DLPFERPA-Discovery.ps1 (PASS). > [CmdletBinding()] param([Parameter(Mandatory)][string]$PolicyName, [ValidateSet('Exchange','SharePoint','OneDrive','Teams','Endpoint')] [string[]]$Locations = @('Exchange'),

[string[]]$SensitiveTypes = @('Student ID - Custom SIT - FERPA'), [int]$MinCount = 5, [ValidateSet('Low','Medium','High')][string]$Confidence = 'High', Simulation flavour: with or without showing policy tips to users during the test. [ValidateSet('TestWithNotifications','TestWithoutNotifications')][string]$SimulationMode = 'TestWithNotifications', [string]$UserPrincipalName, [switch]$Commit)

DLPFERPA-Discovery.ps1

Purpose: Builds the FERPA DLP baseline: every existing DLP compliance policy with its MODE (enforce vs simulation vs disabled) and the locations it covers, plus a summary of sensitive information types (built-in vs custom) and any EDM schemas in the tenant. Highlights whether a student-identifier custom SIT already exists (name matching 'student'). Read-only — makes no changes. Use it to see what already exists before you build simulation policies. HOW TO RUN powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\DLPFERPA-Discovery.ps1 -CsvPath .\DLPFERPA-Posture.csv Requires Security & Compliance PowerShell (Connect-IPPSSession via ExchangeOnlineManagement). .EXAMPLE .\DLPFERPA-Discovery.ps1 -CsvPath .\DLPFERPA-Posture.csv Prints the DLP policy inventory (Name, Mode, Locations) + SIT coverage and exports the inventory CSV. .NOTES Purview — FERPA DLP Pack. Read-only against Security & Compliance PowerShell. Expected results: policies you expect in simulation report a Test* mode; anything already in Enable that you did not intend is flagged for review (PASS = no unexpected Enable). > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$CsvPath, [string]$UserPrincipalName)

How to run: powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\DLPFERPA-Discovery.ps1 -CsvPath .\DLPFERPA-Posture.csv Requires Security & Compliance PowerShell (Connect-IPPSSession via ExchangeOnlineManagement). .EXAMPLE .\DLPFERPA-Discovery.ps1 -CsvPath .\DLPFERPA-Posture.csv Prints the DLP policy inventory (Name, Mode, Locations) + SIT coverage and exports the inventory CSV. .NOTES Purview — FERPA DLP Pack. Read-only against Security & Compliance PowerShell. Expected results: policies you expect in simulation report a Test* mode; anything already in Enable that you did not intend is flagged for review (PASS = no unexpected Enable). > [CmdletBinding()] param([string]$CsvPath, [string]$UserPrincipalName)

DLPFERPA-Report.ps1

Purpose: Exports DLP rule matches (Exchange, SharePoint/OneDrive, Teams, and Endpoint) over a time window so you can classify true-positive vs false-positive and compute the false-positive rate that gates simulation-to-enforcement for the FERPA policy set. Works for policies in simulation AND enforcement — simulation matches are logged the same way. Read-only — queries Search-UnifiedAuditLog only. HOW TO RUN powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\DLPFERPA-Report.ps1 -Days 14 -CsvPath .\DLPFERPA-Matches.csv Requires Security & Compliance PowerShell (Connect-IPPSSession) and audit logging enabled. .EXAMPLE .\DLPFERPA-Report.ps1 -Days 14 -CsvPath .\DLPFERPA-Matches.csv Breaks matches down by workload and policy and exports a per-event CSV with a blank Disposition column. .NOTES Purview — FERPA DLP Pack. Read-only reporting from the unified audit log. No changes made. Expected results: classify each row TP/FP, compute FP rate = FP / (TP+FP); PASS = rate at/under the agreed threshold. > [CmdletBinding()] param([int]$Days = 14, [string]$CsvPath, [string]$UserPrincipalName)

How to run: powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\DLPFERPA-Report.ps1 -Days 14 -CsvPath .\DLPFERPA-Matches.csv Requires Security & Compliance PowerShell (Connect-IPPSSession) and audit logging enabled. .EXAMPLE .\DLPFERPA-Report.ps1 -Days 14 -CsvPath .\DLPFERPA-Matches.csv Breaks matches down by workload and policy and exports a per-event CSV with a blank Disposition

column. .NOTES Purview — FERPA DLP Pack. Read-only reporting from the unified audit log. No changes made. Expected results: classify each row TP/FP, compute FP rate = FP / (TP+FP); PASS = rate at/under the agreed threshold. > [CmdletBinding()] param([int]$Days = 14, [string]$CsvPath, [string]$UserPrincipalName)

DLPFERPA-Set-Scope.ps1

Purpose: Reports a DLP policy's current locations, mode, and member-of scope, and — only with -Commit — narrows an Exchange/OneDrive policy to the FERPA PILOT RING by setting the location member-of scope (ExchangeSenderMemberOf / OneDriveSharedByMemberOf), so enforcement can be limited to a ring before expansion. Safe by default: -WhatIf reports only; writes require -Commit. This helper adjusts SCOPE only — it does NOT flip a policy to enforce (that is a deliberate portal/change-control action, a FERPA/registrar determination). HOW TO RUN Report current scope/health: powershell -File .\DLPFERPA-Set-Scope.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' -WhatIf Restrict the Exchange policy to the FERPA pilot-ring group (still simulation mode): powershell -File .\DLPFERPA-Set-Scope.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' ` -PilotRingGroup 'FERPADLPPilotRing@contoso.com' -Location Exchange -Commit Requires Security & Compliance PowerShell (Connect-IPPSSession). .EXAMPLE .\DLPFERPA-Set-Scope.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' -WhatIf Prints the policy's locations/mode/scope and the Set-DlpCompliancePolicy call it WOULD run. .NOTES Purview — FERPA DLP Pack. Scope changes gated behind -Commit; never changes enforcement mode. No credentials in code. Expected results: -Commit sets the *MemberOf scope to the pilot ring; Mode is unchanged (PASS = ring scoped, still simulation). > [CmdletBinding()] param([Parameter(Mandatory)][string]$PolicyName, [string]$PilotRingGroup, [ValidateSet('Exchange','SharePoint','OneDrive','Teams')][string]$Location = 'Exchange', [string]$UserPrincipalName, [switch]$Commit)

How to run: Report current scope/health: powershell -File .\DLPFERPA-Set-Scope.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' -WhatIf Restrict the Exchange policy to the FERPA pilot-ring group (still simulation mode): powershell -File .\DLPFERPA-Set-Scope.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' ` -PilotRingGroup 'FERPADLPPilotRing@contoso.com' -Location Exchange -Commit Requires Security & Compliance PowerShell (Connect-IPPSSession). .EXAMPLE .\DLPFERPA-Set-Scope.ps1 -PolicyName 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' -WhatIf Prints the policy's locations/mode/scope and the Set-DlpCompliancePolicy call it WOULD run. .NOTES Purview — FERPA DLP Pack. Scope changes gated behind -Commit; never changes enforcement mode. No credentials in code. Expected results: -Commit sets the *MemberOf scope to the pilot ring; Mode is unchanged (PASS = ring scoped, still simulation). > [CmdletBinding()] param([Parameter(Mandatory)][string]$PolicyName, [string]$PilotRingGroup, [ValidateSet('Exchange','SharePoint','OneDrive','Teams')][string]$Location = 'Exchange', [string]$UserPrincipalName, [switch]$Commit)

DLPFERPA-Validate.ps1

Purpose: Checks the education-record DLP policy set against the pilot pass/fail gates: that each named policy is still in SIMULATION (Mode = Test*), that it is scoped to the intended locations, that its rule references the expected education-record sensitive information types (e.g. the Student ID custom SIT), and — where Endpoint is in scope — flags that device onboarding must be confirmed in the portal. Read-only: makes no changes. Run it immediately before any decision to promote a policy to enforce, and again after enforcement to confirm the intended state. HOW TO RUN powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\DLPFERPA-Validate.ps1 `-PolicyNames 'DLP - Email Education Records -`

Simulation' -ExpectedLocations Exchange -ExpectedSITs 'Student ID - Custom SIT - FERPA' Requires Security & Compliance PowerShell (Connect-IPPSSession via ExchangeOnlineManagement). .EXAMPLE .\DLPFERPA-Validate.ps1 -PolicyNames 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' -ExpectedLocations Exchange Prints one PASS/FAIL line per gate for the named policy and an overall result. .NOTES Purview — FERPA DLP Pack. Read-only against Security & Compliance PowerShell. No credentials in code. Expected results: every gate PASS during pilot (policies in simulation, correctly scoped) = safe to proceed to the enforce decision; any FAIL = fix in simulation and re-validate before enforcing. > [CmdletBinding()] param([Parameter(Mandatory)][string[]]$PolicyNames, [ValidateSet('Exchange','SharePoint','OneDrive','Teams','Endpoint')] [string[]]$ExpectedLocations = @('Exchange'), [string[]]$ExpectedSITs = @('Student ID - Custom SIT - FERPA'), Set when you are validating an INTENTIONALLY enforced policy (post-promotion); default expects simulation. [switch]$ExpectEnforce, [string]$UserPrincipalName)

How to run: powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -File .\DLPFERPA-Validate.ps1 -PolicyNames 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' -ExpectedLocations Exchange -ExpectedSITs 'Student ID - Custom SIT - FERPA' Requires Security & Compliance PowerShell (Connect-IPPSSession via ExchangeOnlineManagement). .EXAMPLE .\DLPFERPA-Validate.ps1 -PolicyNames 'DLP - Email Education Records - Simulation' -ExpectedLocations Exchange Prints one PASS/FAIL line per gate for the named policy and an overall result. .NOTES Purview — FERPA DLP Pack. Read-only against Security & Compliance PowerShell. No credentials in code. Expected results: every gate PASS during pilot (policies in simulation, correctly scoped) = safe to proceed to the enforce decision; any FAIL = fix in simulation and re-validate before enforcing. > [CmdletBinding()] param([Parameter(Mandatory)][string[]]$PolicyNames, [ValidateSet('Exchange','SharePoint','OneDrive','Teams','Endpoint')] [string[]]$ExpectedLocations = @('Exchange'), [string[]]$ExpectedSITs = @('Student ID - Custom SIT - FERPA'), Set when you are validating an INTENTIONALLY enforced policy (post-promotion); default expects simulation. [switch]$ExpectEnforce, [string]$UserPrincipalName)